

MedTracker User Manual

Version 1.0

Medication Tracking & Caregiver Alert System

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1. Overview

MedTracker is a web-based medication tracking app designed for phone use. It helps patients take their medications on time and alerts a caregiver when doses are confirmed or missed.

Key Features

- Schedule medications at specific times and days
- Audio alarms at each scheduled time
- One-tap or bulk confirmation of doses taken
- Automatic caregiver push notifications on confirmation
- Urgent caregiver alerts when doses are missed
- Flexible medication editing for changing prescriptions
- Medication grouping for pill container workflows
- Frequency shortcuts (every 4h, 6h, 8h, 12h)
- Complete confirmation history log
- Data export and import for backup
- Works offline — all data stored on the phone
- Installable as a home screen app (no app store needed)

2. Who Needs What

	Patient's Phone	Caregiver's Phone
MedTracker	YES — open in Chrome browser	NO — not needed
ntfy app	NO — not needed	YES — install from app store

How the notification chain works

text

Patient's Phone ntfy.sh Cloud Caregiver's Phone
 (MedTracker in browser) (free relay service) (ntfy app)

Patient taps "Take" -----> sends notification -----> push alert received

Patient misses dose -----> sends urgent alert -----> push alert received

- MedTracker sends notifications through the internet to ntfy.sh servers
- The ntfy app on the caregiver's phone receives those notifications as push alerts

- The two phones never communicate directly — ntfy.sh is the middleman
 - No accounts, no passwords, no subscriptions, completely free
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3. Getting Started

Patient Phone Setup

1. Open **Google Chrome** browser (recommended — best compatibility)
2. Navigate to the MedTracker URL
3. Chrome may prompt "Add to Home Screen" or "Install App" — tap yes
4. If not prompted: tap the Chrome menu (three dots) → "Add to Home Screen"
5. MedTracker now appears as an app icon on the home screen
6. Open it from the home screen — the browser URL bar will be hidden
7. When prompted, **Allow Notifications** — this enables alarm popups

Caregiver Phone Setup

1. Install the **ntfy** app:
 - Android: [Google Play Store](#)
 - iPhone: [Apple App Store](#)
2. Open the ntfy app
3. Tap + or **Subscribe**
4. Enter a unique topic name (e.g., medtracker-smith-7749)
 - Use only letters, numbers, and hyphens
 - Make it unique and hard to guess — anyone who knows the topic name can see messages
 - Do NOT include https://ntfy.sh/ — just the topic name
5. Tap Subscribe
6. Ensure ntfy has notification permissions enabled in phone settings

Connecting the Two

1. On the **patient's phone**, open MedTracker
2. Go to **Settings** (bottom navigation bar, gear icon)
3. Under **Caregiver Notifications**, enter the **exact same topic name** used in the ntfy app
4. Enter the patient's name in the Patient Name field
5. Tap **Send Test Notification**
6. The caregiver should receive a push notification on their phone
7. If successful, the connection is confirmed

4. Adding Medications

Step by Step

1. Tap the **Meds** tab in the bottom navigation
2. Tap the purple **+** button (bottom right)
3. Fill in the medication details:

Field	Required	Description	Example
Name	Yes	Medication name	Ibuprofen
Dose	No	Amount per dose	800mg, 2 tablets, 5n
RX Number	No	Prescription number	RX-7234891
Treatment For	No	What condition it treats	Pain, Blood pressure
Additional Info	No	Special instructions	Take with food
Group	No	Container/group name	Morning Pills

Setting Schedule Times

You have two options:

Option A: Manual time entry

1. Tap **+ Add Time**
2. Use the phone's time picker to select the time
3. Tap to confirm

4. Repeat for additional times
5. Each time appears as a removable chip

Option B: Frequency shortcuts

1. Tap one of the quick buttons: **Every 4h, Every 6h, Every 8h, Every 12h**
2. A time picker appears — select the starting time
3. Tap **Set**
4. Times are automatically generated forward through the day

Examples:

- Every 4h starting at 8:30 AM → 8:30 AM, 12:30 PM, 4:30 PM, 8:30 PM
- Every 6h starting at 6:00 AM → 6:00 AM, 12:00 PM, 6:00 PM
- Every 8h starting at 7:00 AM → 7:00 AM, 3:00 PM, 11:00 PM
- Every 12h starting at 8:00 AM → 8:00 AM, 8:00 PM

Clear Times removes all set times so you can start over.

Setting Days of Week

- **Purple/highlighted** = medication is taken on this day
- **Dark** = medication is NOT taken on this day
- By default, all days are selected (daily)
- Tap individual days to toggle them on/off
- Quick buttons:
 - **All Days** — selects every day (daily)
 - **Weekdays** — Monday through Friday only
 - **None** — deselects all days

Color Coding

- Tap a color dot to assign a color to the medication
- Colors appear as a stripe next to the medication on the schedule
- Useful for visually identifying different medications at a glance

Saving

- Tap **Add Medication** to save
- A green confirmation toast appears: "✓ Ibuprofen added!"
- The medication immediately appears on the Schedule and Meds pages

5. Daily Use — Taking Medications

The Schedule Page

The Schedule page (default view) shows all medications organized by time for the current day.

Status indicators:

Symbol	Meaning
Purple dot	Upcoming — not yet due
Orange dot + "NOW"	Currently due (within 5 minutes)
Red dot + warning	Past due — not yet confirmed
Green dot + checkmark	All medications confirmed for this time
(3/5)	3 out of 5 medications confirmed

Confirming Individual Medications

1. Find the medication on the schedule
2. Tap the purple **Take** button
3. The medication turns green with a checkmark and timestamp
4. Caregiver receives a push notification (if enabled)

Confirming All Medications at Once

When multiple medications are scheduled at the same time:

1. A green **TAKE ALL X MEDICATIONS** button appears at the top of the time group
2. Tap it
3. A confirmation popup lists all medications

4. Tap OK to confirm all at once
5. All medications turn green
6. Caregiver receives a notification for each medication

Navigating Days

- Use the ◀ and ▶ arrows to view previous or future days
 - Tap the ⦿ button to return to today
 - You can confirm past medications that were missed
 - Future days show the schedule but no Take buttons
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6. Alarm System

How Alarms Work

- MedTracker checks every 30 seconds for due medications
- When the current time matches a scheduled medication time (within 1 minute), the alarm fires
- The alarm consists of:
 - An audio alert (configurable sound)
 - Phone vibration (if enabled)
 - A full-screen overlay showing which medications are due
 - A browser notification (if permissions were granted)

The Alarm Screen

When an alarm fires, a full-screen overlay appears showing:

- The scheduled time
- List of all medications due
- A large green ✓ **TAKEN** button — confirms all medications at once
- A smaller orange **Snooze** button — delays the alarm

Snooze

- Tap Snooze to delay the alarm by the configured number of minutes (default: 10)
- The alarm will fire again after the snooze period
- Snooze does NOT confirm the medications

Important: Keep MedTracker Open

- Alarms only work while MedTracker is open or running in the background
 - Adding to the home screen helps keep it running
 - On Android: Go to phone Settings → Apps → Chrome → Battery → set to "Unrestricted"
 - Avoid force-closing Chrome or the MedTracker app
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7. Caregiver Notifications

Confirmation Notifications

When enabled, the caregiver receives a push notification every time the patient confirms a medication. This provides peace of mind that medications are being taken.

Example notification:

Confirmed: Ibuprofen

Jane took Ibuprofen 800mg at 8:30 AM (8:32 AM)

Missed Dose Notifications

When enabled, the caregiver receives an **urgent** push notification if a medication has not been confirmed within the configured time window (default: 60 minutes after the scheduled time).

Example notification:

MISSED: Ibuprofen

Jane has NOT confirmed Ibuprofen 800mg scheduled for 8:30 AM. 60+ minutes have passed.

Configuring Notifications

In Settings → Caregiver Notifications:

Setting	Description
ntfy.sh Topic	Must match exactly on both phones
Caregiver Name	For reference only
Notify on Confirmation	Send push when med is taken
Notify on Missed Dose	Send urgent push when missed
Alert after (minutes)	How long to wait before sending missed alert

Testing the Connection

1. Go to Settings
2. Enter the ntfy topic name
3. Tap **Send Test Notification**
4. A success/failure message appears
5. Check the ntfy app on the caregiver's phone

8. Managing Medications

Editing a Medication

1. Go to the **Meds** tab
2. Tap the **pencil icon** next to the medication
3. Modify any field — name, dose, times, days, etc.
4. Tap **Save Changes**

Deactivating a Medication

If a medication is temporarily stopped but may resume:

1. Edit the medication
2. Toggle the **Active** switch off
3. Save Changes
4. The medication appears dimmed in the Meds list
5. It will NOT appear on the Schedule or trigger alarms

6. Toggle it back on when needed

Deleting a Medication

1. Go to the **Meds** tab
2. Tap the **trash icon** next to the medication
3. Confirm the deletion
4. The medication is permanently removed
5. Historical confirmation records are preserved

When the Doctor Changes Medications

1. **Changed dose:** Edit the medication → update the Dose field
 2. **Changed frequency:** Edit → remove old times → add new times or use frequency buttons
 3. **New medication:** Add a new medication
 4. **Stopped medication:** Deactivate or delete it
 5. **Temporary medication:** Add it normally → deactivate or delete when the course is complete
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9. Groups & Containers

What Groups Are For

Groups help organize medications that are taken together — particularly useful for patients who pre-fill daily pill containers.

Setting Up Groups

1. When adding or editing a medication, enter a **Group** name
2. Use consistent naming: "Morning Pills", "Afternoon Pills", "Evening Pills"
3. All medications with the same group name and same time will appear together on the schedule

Using Groups with Pill Containers

Scenario: Patient takes 5 different medications in the morning, 3 in the afternoon, 4 in the evening.

1. Add all morning medications with Group = "Morning Container" and the same time (e.g., 8:00 AM)
2. Add all afternoon medications with Group = "Afternoon Container" and the same time (e.g., 1:00 PM)
3. Add all evening medications with Group = "Evening Container" and the same time (e.g., 7:00 PM)
4. On the schedule, each time slot shows a **TAKE ALL** button
5. Patient takes the entire container → taps TAKE ALL → all confirmed at once

Group Badges

On the Schedule page, each medication's group name appears as a small badge next to the medication name for quick identification.

10. History

Viewing History

1. Tap the **History** tab in the bottom navigation
2. Confirmation records are organized by date, most recent first
3. Each entry shows:
 - Medication name and dose
 - Scheduled time
 - Actual confirmation time

History Retention

- History is stored locally on the patient's phone
- Up to 14 days are displayed at a time
- All records remain in storage until manually cleared
- Use **Clear History** to remove all records

Exporting History

History is included when you export data (Settings → Data → Export). The exported JSON file contains all confirmation records.

11. Settings Reference

Patient Section

Setting	Description
Patient Name	Displayed in caregiver notifications

Alarm Sound Section

Setting	Description
Sound selection	Choose from 6 built-in sounds or upload custom
Volume slider	Adjust alarm volume (0-100%)
Sound Enabled	Toggle audio alarms on/off
Vibration	Toggle phone vibration on/off
Snooze (minutes)	How long snooze delays the alarm (1-30 min)

Caregiver Notifications Section

Setting	Description
ntfy.sh Topic	Unique name shared between patient and caregiver
Caregiver Name	For reference
Notify on Confirmation	Push when medication is taken
Notify on Missed Dose	Urgent push when medication is missed
Alert after (minutes)	Time window before missed alert is sent (5-180 min)

Data Section

Button	Description
Export	Downloads all data as a JSON file
Import	Loads data from a previously exported JSON file

12. Alarm Sounds

Six built-in alarm sounds are available:

Sound	Description	Best For
Classic Alarm	Rapid alternating beeps	General use
Urgent Siren	Rising and falling siren	Heavy sleepers
Medical Alert	Hospital-style triple beep pattern	Familiar clinical feel
Harsh Buzzer	Loud, grating buzz	Very difficult to ignore
Escalating	Starts soft, gets louder and higher	Gradual wake-up
Gentle Chime	Soft melodic chime	Light sleepers, quiet environment

Previewing Sounds

In Settings → Alarm Sound:

- Tap the ► button on any sound tile to preview it
- The preview plays at the currently set volume level

Selecting a Sound

Tap the sound tile to select it. The active sound has a purple border.

13. Custom Sounds

Uploading a Custom Sound

1. Go to Settings → Alarm Sound
2. Tap the **Custom** tile, or tap **Upload Custom Sound**
3. Select an audio file from your phone
4. Supported formats: MP3, WAV, OGG, M4A, AAC
5. Maximum file size: 10 MB
6. The sound is stored locally and persists across sessions

Managing Custom Sounds

- **Preview:** Tap the ► button on the Custom tile
- **Replace:** Tap the folder icon next to the file name
- **Remove:** Tap the X button next to the file name

Tips for Custom Sounds

- Use a short clip (5-15 seconds) — it will loop automatically
 - Louder source files work better
 - Test at different volume levels
 - Make sure the sound is attention-getting enough to wake someone up
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14. Data Backup & Restore

Exporting Data

1. Go to Settings → Data → **Export**
2. A JSON file downloads containing:
 - All medications and their settings
 - All confirmation history
 - App settings (except custom alarm audio)
3. File is named medtracker-YYYY-MM-DD.json

Importing Data

1. Go to Settings → Data → **Import**
2. Select a previously exported JSON file
3. All data is restored
4. Existing data is replaced

When to Export

- Before clearing the browser/app data
- Before switching to a new phone
- As a regular backup (weekly recommended)
- Before making major changes to the medication list

Note

Custom alarm sounds are stored separately in the browser's IndexedDB and are NOT included in the export. You will need to re-upload the custom sound file after importing on a new device.

15. Tips & Best Practices

For Reliable Alarms

1. **Add to home screen** — keeps the app running better
2. **Disable battery optimization** for Chrome — prevents Android from killing it
3. **Keep the phone plugged in** at night if overnight medications are needed
4. **Set multiple notification methods** — the in-app alarm plus caregiver alerts provide redundancy

For Caregivers

1. **Set the missed dose timer appropriately** — 60 minutes is the default, but adjust based on the medication's importance
2. **Enable both confirmation and missed alerts** — confirmation alerts provide reassurance, missed alerts are the safety net
3. **Choose a unique, hard-to-guess topic name** — anyone who knows the topic can read the notifications
4. **Keep the ntfy app's notifications unrestricted** — disable Do Not Disturb exceptions if needed

For Patients on Sleep-Inducing Medications

1. Use the **Harsh Buzzer** or **Urgent Siren** alarm sound
2. Set volume to **100%**
3. Enable **Vibration**
4. Place the phone on a hard surface (amplifies vibration)
5. Keep the phone nearby (nightstand, not across the room)
6. The caregiver missed-dose alert serves as a backup if the patient sleeps through

For Frequently Changing Medications

1. Use the **Active toggle** to deactivate medications instead of deleting them
 2. This preserves the medication details in case they need to be restarted
 3. Edit the dose field when dosages change rather than deleting and re-adding
 4. Export data before making major changes as a safety backup
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16. Troubleshooting

App shows "Loading..."

- **Use Google Chrome** — other browsers (DuckDuckGo, Firefox) may have compatibility issues
- Clear browser cache and reload
- Check the browser console for error messages (Chrome menu → More Tools → Developer Tools)

Alarm doesn't sound

- Ensure **Sound Enabled** is on in Settings
- Ensure phone is not on Silent/Vibrate mode
- Tap anywhere on the screen first — browsers require a user interaction before playing audio
- Check that the phone's media volume is turned up (not just ringer volume)
- Make sure MedTracker is open or running in the background

Caregiver not receiving notifications

- Verify the **topic name matches exactly** on both phones (case-sensitive)
- Tap **Send Test Notification** and read the result message
- Check that the ntfy app is subscribed to the correct topic

- Ensure the ntfy app has notification permissions on the caregiver's phone
- Check that the caregiver's phone is not in Do Not Disturb mode
- Try unsubscribing and re-subscribing to the topic in the ntfy app

Medications not saving

- Make sure the **Name** field is filled in (required)
- Make sure at least one **Schedule Time** is added (required)
- If days are all deselected, the app will ask to set to daily

Schedule shows "No meds scheduled today"

- Check that medications are set to **Active** (not deactivated)
- Check that the current day of the week is selected in the medication's days
- Go to the Meds tab to verify medications exist

App lost all data

- Browser data was cleared, or a different browser was used
- If you have an export file, use Settings → Import to restore
- Going forward, export data regularly as a backup

Phone kills the app in the background

Android:

1. Settings → Apps → Chrome → Battery → Unrestricted
2. Settings → Battery → Battery Optimization → Chrome → Don't Optimize

iPhone:

1. Add to Home Screen from Safari
2. Background App Refresh must be enabled for Safari

17. FAQ

Q: Does MedTracker cost anything?

A: No. MedTracker is free. The ntfy.sh notification service is also free.

Q: Do I need an account or login?

A: No. There are no accounts. Data is stored locally on the phone.

Q: Can multiple caregivers receive notifications?

A: Yes. Anyone who subscribes to the same ntfy topic in the ntfy app will receive all notifications. Share the topic name with additional caregivers.

Q: What happens if the phone loses internet?

A: Alarms still work — they run locally. Caregiver notifications will not be sent until internet is restored. Confirmed doses are logged locally regardless of internet.

Q: Can I track medications for multiple people?

A: The app is designed for one patient per device. For multiple patients, use separate phones or browser profiles, each with a different ntfy topic.

Q: Is my medication data private?

A: Yes. All medication data is stored only on the patient's phone in the browser's local storage. Nothing is uploaded to any server. The only data sent externally is the notification content sent through ntfy.sh when doses are confirmed or missed.

Q: What if the doctor changes the medication schedule?

A: Edit the medication in the Meds tab. You can change the dose, times, days, instructions, or any other field. Changes take effect immediately.

Q: Can I use this on a computer?

A: Yes, but it is designed for phone use. Alarms and vibration work best on mobile devices.

Q: What browsers are supported?

A: Google Chrome is recommended and fully supported. Safari on iPhone works for basic features. DuckDuckGo browser and Firefox may have limited compatibility.

Q: How do I move MedTracker to a new phone?

A: Export your data on the old phone (Settings → Export), transfer the JSON file to the new phone, open MedTracker on the new phone, and Import the file. Re-upload any custom alarm sound separately.

MedTracker — Built with care for caregivers and patients.